Republic of the Philippines
DEPARTMENT OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY
Philippine Atmospheric, Geophysical and Astronomical Services Administration (PAGASA)
Climatology and Agrometeorology Division (CAD)
Climate Monitoring and Prediction Section (CLIMPS)

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BAGONG PILIPINAS

ENSO ADVISORY

El Niño Advisory No. 4

Moderate to strong El Niño is present in the tropical Pacific. Forecasts indicate that El Niño will continue until the first half of 2027 and may reach a very strong state in the coming months before peaking towards the end of 2026.

El Niño increases the likelihood of below-normal rainfall, which may lead to adverse climate impacts, including dry spells and droughts in some areas of the country. However, over the western part of the country, above-normal rainfall conditions during the Southwest monsoon season (i.e., *Habagat)* may also occur.

Assessment for August 2026

The weather systems that influenced the weather and climate of the country during the month were the Southwest Monsoon, localized thunderstorms, low-pressure areas (LPAs), and the passage of five (5) tropical cyclones (TCs) in the Philippine Area of Responsibility (PAR): Tropical Depression (TD) “Luis” from 01 to 03 August, Tropical Storm (TS) “Maymay” (KUJIRA) from 04 to 07 August, TD “Neneng” from 18 to 20 August, Typhoon (TY) “Obet” (SAUDEL) in 24 August and TS “Pilandok” (KROVANH) from 30 August to 03 September.

The passage of these TCs enhanced the SW monsoon, bringing episodes of heavy rainfall which led to way above normal rainfall condition that triggered flooding and rain-induced landslides, especially in western and Central Luzon, and parts of Western Visayas. According to the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Council Situational Report No. 30 issued on 01 September 2026, the combined effects of the Enhanced Southwest Monsoon and TCs LUIS, MAYMAY, and NENENG primarily affected Region I, CAR, Region 3, CALABARZON, MIMAROPA, and Region 6 caused widespread agricultural damage of over Php 2.2 billion and infrastructure damage of over Php 6.3 billion.

The rainfall assessment for the month showed that most areas in Luzon experienced above-normal conditions except Bicol Region, and most of Western Visayas, while below to way-below normal rainfall for the rest of the country.

In addition, seven (7) provinces experienced meteorological drought, most of which were in Bicol Region and Visayas; four (4) provinces were under dry spell, and one (1) province experienced dry condition. For a complete list of these provinces, please refer to the meteorological **Drought/Dry Spell Assessment** Maps and Tables.

Slightly above to above-average mean surface air temperatures were observed over most parts of the country during the month, except for select areas in La Union, Pangasinan, Zambales, Northern Palawan, and Camarines Sur where cooler-than-average temperatures were recorded. The recorded temperature ranges were as follows: mountainous areas of Luzon (15.8 – 24.6°C); Metro Manila (23.1 – 33.2°C); rest of Luzon (19.8 – 37.2°C); Visayas (23.0 – 37.5°C); mountainous areas of Mindanao (17.7 – 33.4°C); rest of Mindanao (21.0 – 37.5°C). Meanwhile, four (4) observation stations established new maximum temperature extremes for August: Puerto Princesa, Palawan on August 07 (35.4°C); Catbalogan, Samar on August 10 (36.5°C); Butuan City on August 10 (36.5°C) and Hinatuan, Surigao del Sur on August 09 (37.5°C).

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Outlook for September 2026

The weather systems expected to affect the weather and climate of the country in September are the Southwest Monsoon, easterlies, LPAs, ITCZ, localized thunderstorms, ridge of the high-pressure area (HPA), and the occurrence of two (2) or three (3) TCs that may develop within or enter the PAR.

The rainfall forecast for September suggests that a below-normal rainfall condition will likely be experienced in most parts of Northern Luzon, Zambales, Bataan, Davao del Sur, Davao Occidental, and Sarangani, while near-normal conditions are expected over the rest of the country. This is supported by the probabilistic forecast, suggesting a high chance of below-normal rainfall in the northern part of Luzon and some areas in Southern Mindanao and near to above-normal rainfall for the rest of Luzon, Visayas, and the rest of Mindanao.

Based on observed rainfall during the past months and the forecast for September, meteorological drought/dry spells are likely to be experienced by the end of the month in Camarines Sur, and dry condition over some areas in Southern Mindanao.

Meanwhile, near-average to warmer-than-average mean temperatures are expected over most parts of the country, aside from slightly cooler-than-average conditions over some areas in Southern Luzon and Bohol. The ranges of forecast temperature are as follows: 14.1 – 27.0°C in the mountainous areas of Luzon, 21.9 – 35.9°C for Metro Manila, 20.9 – 37.2°C over the rest of Luzon, 20.4 – 36.2°C in Visayas, 15.4 – 33.6°C in the mountainous areas of Mindanao, and 20.6 – 37.9°C over the rest of Mindanao.

DOST-PAGASA will continue to closely monitor the ongoing El Niño and its associated impacts on the country's climate. Meanwhile, all government agencies and the general public are strongly advised to take appropriate preparedness and response measures to mitigate their potential impacts, particularly in areas vulnerable to heavy rainfall and floods during Habagat season and those areas prone to below-normal rainfall conditions.

For more information, please call the Climatology and Agrometeorology Division (CAD) at (02)8284-0800 local 4920 or 4921.

Originally Signed

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Administrator

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